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HOMEOWNER GUIDE

Sell, Remodel, Rent, or Hold.

Guidance for your next move. Clarity before you decide.

01. YOUR OPTIONS

A clear look at your options.

Most homeowners considering a sale want clarity before committing, especially when they're unsure what their home might realistically sell for in today's market.

While every property is different, understanding a reasonable price range is often the first step in deciding whether selling, remodeling, renting, or holding makes the most sense.

Whether you're still weighing your options or already leaning toward selling, it helps to step back and compare the paths side by side.

Selling, remodeling, renting, or holding can all make sense depending on your goals, timeline, and stress level. The key is understanding which direction truly fits your situation.

This guide slows the decision down, lays out the tradeoffs clearly, and helps you avoid unnecessary or costly moves before you commit.

THE FOUR PATHS STRATEGY

Sell

WHEN IT MAKES SENSE

You need liquidity, a different space, or want to capture current equity.

RISKS & TRADEOFFS

Giving up future appreciation and potential rental income.

FINANCIAL UPSIDE

Immediate access to net proceeds for your next move or investment.

BEST FOR

Homeowners ready for a clean break and financial flexibility.

Remodel

WHEN IT MAKES SENSE

Your home has good bones but needs updates or improvements.

FINANCIAL UPSIDE

Improved quality of life and potential increase in resale value. In some cases, it may also create the option to access equity for a future move.

RISKS & TRADEOFFS

High upfront costs; luxury upgrades rarely deliver a 100% ROI.

BEST FOR

Homeowners who love their location but want their home to work better.

Rent

WHEN IT MAKES SENSE

Your mortgage payment is low and you want to build long-term wealth.

FINANCIAL UPSIDE

Long-term equity growth and potential for future appreciation.

RISKS & TRADEOFFS

Ongoing maintenance, tenant management, and vacancy risks.

BEST FOR

Investors focused on long-term wealth rather than immediate cash flow.

Hold

WHEN IT MAKES SENSE

You need more time to decide or market conditions don't favor your goals.

FINANCIAL UPSIDE

Avoids transaction costs and allows for more clarity before acting.

RISKS & TRADEOFFS

Equity remains tied up in the home; ongoing taxes, insurance, and maintenance costs.

BEST FOR

Homeowners who aren't under pressure and value certainty over speed.

02. PREPARING VS SELLING

Know the difference before listing.

Before listing your home, it's important to understand when preparation makes financial sense and when it doesn't. Many sellers spend money on repairs and upgrades that don't meaningfully increase value or buyer demand.

WHAT MATTERS

Basic cleanliness, functional systems, and neutral presentation help buyers see themselves in the space.

WHAT DOESN'T

Major renovations, luxury upgrades, and personal taste projects rarely deliver full return on investment.

ASK YOURSELF

Will this improvement meaningfully increase buyer interest or net proceeds? If the answer isn't clear, reconsider it.

03. PRICING STRATEGY

Your most important decision.

Pricing your home correctly is one of the most important decisions you'll make. It affects both how your home is perceived and the outcome you ultimately achieve. The right price isn't about chasing the market or maximizing every dollar. It's about positioning your home where it belongs.

UNDERPRICING RISK

Selling too low means leaving money on the table. Buyers may question if there's something wrong with the property.

THOUGHTFUL PRICING

Starting too high can make your home invisible to most buyers and lead to reductions that signal distress.

04. SELLING VS RENTING

Understanding your tradeoffs.

THE REALITY OF RENTING

Keeping your home as a rental brings ongoing responsibility. You'll need to handle tenant screening, maintenance, property management, and vacancy periods. There are real monthly costs beyond the mortgage, including insurance, repairs, property taxes, and management fees, and you need cash reserves for unexpected expenses and vacancies.

In our local market, renting is often more of a long-term equity and appreciation play than a strong cash-flow strategy. It tends to make the most sense when your payment is low relative to rents or when your goal is long-term wealth building rather than immediate income.

Renting can provide future appreciation and possibly some monthly income, but it keeps your equity tied up and limits flexibility. You're still affected by changes in home values and rental demand while responsible for the property.

THE REALITY OF SELLING

Selling provides liquidity and releases you from ongoing property responsibility. You're no longer tied to the home, responsible for repairs, or managing tenants. The equity becomes available for your next move, investment, or other financial goals.

The tradeoff is giving up future appreciation and potential rental income. Once sold, you no longer participate in future market gains tied to the property.

Renting and selling can both be smart decisions depending on timing, finances, and goals. The right choice depends on your financial position, risk tolerance, and long-term plans. For some homeowners, the equity sitting in this property is the capital that funds the next one.

05. HOLDING

Doing nothing can be strategic.

WAITING MAKES SENSE WHEN

- You need time to decide your next move
- You prefer to wait until conditions feel more favorable
- You're not ready to commit to selling or renting

CONSIDER THE COSTS

- Your equity remains tied up in the home
- Ongoing maintenance and holding costs
- Future market timing is impossible to predict
- You're still responsible for property taxes and insurance

Holding your property isn't procrastination. It can be a valid strategy when you need clarity or when market conditions don't favor your goals.

Understanding the tradeoffs.

Selling your home as-is means offering it in its current condition without making repairs or updates. This isn't a marketing gimmick or a way to get a fast sale. It's simply acknowledging the property's state.

WHAT TO CONSIDER

- Buyers will inspect and negotiate based on condition
- You may receive lower offers if the price doesn't reflect the home's condition
- It can take longer to find the right buyer
- You're not obligated to make any improvements

This option works when you don't want to invest time or money preparing the home, or when the property needs repairs or updates you don't want to take on. It's a tradeoff between price, preparation, and effort.

REMODEL

Remodel

Remodeling can be a way to make your current home work better for your needs or to better position it for resale.

For many homeowners, this means improving layout, updating key areas, or addressing functional issues that impact daily living or buyer perception.

A strategic remodel paired with a refinance can, in certain situations, reposition the property for a different use or outcome, or free up capital for the next move.

07. PUTTING IT TOGETHER

The best choice depends on four key factors.

There's no single right answer. Only the right answer for your situation.

YOUR GOALS

What are you trying to achieve? More space, financial flexibility, retirement planning, or something else?

YOUR TIMELINE

When do you need to make a decision? Are you under pressure, or do you have time to wait?

YOUR HOME'S CONDITION

What shape is your property in? Are there major issues, minor updates, or is it move-in ready?

YOUR CAPACITY

How much effort and uncertainty are you willing to handle? Some paths require more involvement than others.

Mario Manzano

SELLER STRATEGIST

Helping homeowners across the Austin area develop a clear strategy around selling, remodeling, renting, or holding.

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